Connector 2.10.16

Contract 15.0 | 21 October 2026 | Local verification

The 2.10.15 handoff stopped with engineering tasks unfinished. This update completes the additional changes listed below. A 10/10 rating remains unproven.

Automated tests	MCP smoke checks	Hinted source pages
349 passed	18 passed	18 / 18 in top five

What changed

Canonical evidence cache

Validated full evidence is cached before compact/ultra formatting. Changing detail or expansions reuses retrieval; source quotes and provenance remain available.

Indexed ranking inputs

42,976 units now store source-word/concept positions. Versioned rule weights use these inputs; relation routes retain a reserved candidate floor and requested predicates. This is a rule baseline, not a trained or calibrated model.

Lossless minimal responses

Contract 15 publishes its complete decoder legend in tools/list. Shared qasida records, speaker/morphology objects and expansion inheritance remove repetition while retaining uncertainty and citation identity.

Evidence excerpts

Visible excerpts include the complete cited span and honor the requested context. Original source text and all 44 raw files are unchanged.

Build and monitoring reliability

Index builds publish only after commit and integrity checking. Failed builds retain the previous index. Traffic summaries isolate the current build and measure the interval actually observed.

Verification limits

The 28 disclosed calls returned zero errors; local replay p95 was 1393 ms. Eight concurrent SDK requests returned zero errors (local maximum 4119 ms; cache reuse allowed). These are local observations, not production SLO evidence.

Corpus audit passed: 43 books / 6,935 pages and 95 qasidas / 2,682 bayts. All 44 original raw files are unchanged; seven literal/lexeme controls retain counts and locators. Public page hints are development data, not independently judged answers.

Payload and acceptance evidence

Control / actual hits	Encoding	Compact	Ultra	Reduction
Question / 1	cl100k_base	784	505	35.59%
Question / 1	o200k_base	718	456	36.49%
Conjunction / 5	cl100k_base	2633	1897	27.95%
Conjunction / 5	o200k_base	2179	1514	30.52%
Lexical / 6	cl100k_base	2448	1594	34.89%
Lexical / 6	o200k_base	2016	1268	37.1%
Census / 5	cl100k_base	2268	1608	29.1%
Census / 5	o200k_base	1919	1352	29.55%
Weak negative / 0	cl100k_base	654	476	27.22%
Weak negative / 0	o200k_base	638	461	27.74%

Tiktoken 0.12.0. Decoded evidence, provenance and returned counts are equal. The six-result control meets the 25% payload target under both encodings. The question control uses context_chars=40 and is under 1,500 bytes. Tool discovery includes the complete decoder legend; there is no extra metadata hydration call. Schema and follow-up costs are in the JSON report. Payload savings do not imply the same reduction for a full conversation.

The original harness named a five-hit conjunction a six-hit control. Both controls now appear separately, and the six-hit case asserts exactly six results. A 5% growth gate runs during Docker builds. Actual Docker image execution was unavailable here.

Still required before a 10/10 claim

Arabic/domain review

The development lexicon and weights are unreviewed. A large reviewed concept/lemma/POS set, sensitive speaker decisions, support calibration and documentary provenance require qualified reviewers and source evidence. A contextual morphology model is not claimed.

Independent quality evaluation

Run an independently owned and graded private set. The supplied 10-tier gate requires 1,002 wordings / 334 intent families, Direct@5 >=99%, Direct@1 >=95%, per-stratum/family checks and reviewed mixed-hit labels. Public page hints are development checks.

Deployment and observation

Render access was unavailable and this release is not deployed. Refresh real clients after deployment. Retain >=7 days / 10,000 representative attempts on durable storage and verify production latency/failure limits. No Docker daemon was available for an image-build test.

Handoff

Follow START_HERE.md, rebuild the index and confirm 2.10.16 / contract 15. Refresh client tools/list. The ZIP contains code, executable checks, raw verification reports and a detailed acceptance register. No deployment or independent reviewer approval is claimed.